

Why are AI Servers and servers in general not in Tundras or other freezing biomes that can use the cold temperature to cool down the technology instead of using water and electricity.

Posted by u/ReflectionNo492 • 0 points • 13 comments

What I mean is like have funnels in to the servers from the cold outside. It is like an infinite cooling supply. But if it gets too cold, there are sensors to limit the airflow inside, thus always keeping it at a perfect temperature.

Now, I know this is quite dumb, but why is it dumb?

Comments

u/archpaw • 1 points • 2025-05-23 02:12 UTC

If you really want a lot of cooling, liquid cooling is your best bet. And it's hard to get that if you're in an environment where water keeps freezing.

u/Nuts4WrestlingButts • 3 points • 2025-05-23 01:37 UTC

There would have to be a lot of infrastructure built before you could do that. Electricity, data lines, roads, workers.

u/ReflectionNo492 • 0 points • 2025-05-23 01:39 UTC

Is it beneficial in the long run?

u/Nuts4WrestlingButts • 1 points • 2025-05-23 04:39 UTC

You also don't want your internet coming from Greenland or Siberia or the Northern Territories when you're down further south. You want datacenters close to you or the network will have horrendous ping.

u/Own-Barnacle-298 • 2 points • 2025-05-23 01:50 UTC

companies don't really look at The Long Run. they used to but now it's more like 4-year plans. Also, they don't want to build infrastructure, they want governments to foot that bill

u/hellshot8 • 3 points • 2025-05-23 01:37 UTC

you want to go work in the tundra?

u/ReflectionNo492 • 0 points • 2025-05-23 01:38 UTC

Or similar cool places. Like Alaska. There is already a population there, now they can be provided new jobs and spur their economy.

u/Dry_System9339 • 2 points • 2025-05-23 01:49 UTC

The government offices in the Canadian Arctic need air conditioning in the summer.

u/generic_redditor_71 • 6 points • 2025-05-23 01:34 UTC

There is no power, internet connection or workers in the tundra. It's a lot easier and cheaper to pay for cooling in a normal location than to being all of those things to a frozen wasteland.

u/ReflectionNo492 • 2 points • 2025-05-23 01:37 UTC

I keep seeing these articles like "ChatGPT is bad for the environment" and what not. Is it not cheaper to import all those things in the long run as to not continuously pay for cooling?

u/archpaw • 1 points • 2025-05-23 02:19 UTC

[It's not particularly bad for the environment.](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>)

But it still could be improved. Rather than trying to reduce the power, you'd likely be better off trying to use environmentally friendly power sources. Go somewhere with cheap geothermal or nuclear power. The best way to encourage this would be to tax all the environmentally damaging power sources, or failing that, subsidize environmentally friendly power.

u/MrWedge18 • 2 points • 2025-05-23 02:01 UTC

The main environmental impact is the sheer amount of electricity used, which means more fossil fuels. Power plants have either postponed their planned shutdowns or have restarted in order to keep up with AI demand. That doesn't change regardless of location. Plus dumping heat directly into an Arctic environment would have its own impact.

There's also concerns of contaminated water being released, but that's a much more solvable problem (eg filtration and purification). It's just a matter of getting companies and governments to actually bother solving it.

u/generic_redditor_71 • 4 points • 2025-05-23 01:38 UTC

These articles are rage bait for people who are angry about AI. Cooling data centers is a concern, but it's not even close to the biggest cost.